

itory of files for most Windows applications. Over a period of time, this folder starts bloating, and this, to a certain extent, results in performance degradation. It might be a good idea to move the target location of the 'My Documents' folder to some other partition on the hard drive, or to a different drive.

To do so, right click on 'My Documents', and on the 'Target' tab, click on 'Move'. In the subsequent dialog box, browse to the drive where you want to move the folder. Then click 'Make New Folder' to create a new folder, and name it appropriately. Click 'Apply' and then 'Yes'.



Moving the 'My Documents' Folder

8.2 The Page File

The page file, also called the virtual memory, is the part of the hard drive that the operating system uses as though it were main memory. The virtual memory comes into the picture when the physical memory cannot hold the data that the application requires it to. Since hard drives are much slower as compared to RAM, accessing data from virtual memory is slower, and there is naturally a significant effect on system performance. Moreover, Windows XP uses the virtual memory all the time, regardless of free physical memory, so optimisation of the page file is essential for a faster system.

There are two important aspects to the page file—its size and its location.